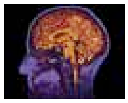
Absolutely chilling
China develops refrigerator capable of cooling to near zero temperatures.
https://dgit.in/july21-114



Using AI to prevent dementia
UF researchers are developing a method using AI, hoping it will prevent Alzheimer's and Dementia. **https://dgit.in/july21-115**

to two-thirds of the computation power used for cryptocurrencies and two provinces in China with cheap electricity, Xinjiang and Sichuan, accounted for half of that figure.

Aside from your neighbours hating you for usurping their power supply, even banks hate cryptocurrencies since it completely bypasses the traditional currency system. So China has started cracking down on crypto. Well, they've been doing it for a while but miners have found loopholes and workarounds. The Chinese currency RMB made up about 90 per cent of the crypto-to-FIAT transactions until China banned the use of RMB for crypto transactions. That didn't stop miners as they simply channeled the funds overseas and used other FIAT currencies to transact with cryptocurrencies. No government likes being subverted to this extent, so the latest move by China has authorised banks to identify individuals and firms involved in cryptocurrencies and cut down their payment channels. Basically, China is casting a wider net to catch those flouting their cryptocurrency norms.

This latest move has caused miners to offload all the graphics cards that were in use to mine cryptocurrencies. And they've been doing it quickly. Graphics card prices, which had hit 304% in mid-May 2021 have already dropped to 153% and they're rapidly dropping by the day. We won't see such a rapid drop in prices in India since dealers here have a habit of hoarding and riding the higher prices as long as they can but it will drop nevertheless.

Major manufacturers are yet to weigh in and let us know when these prices will normalise but it finally seems like gamers would be able to build or upgrade their gaming PCs sooner than what we had all estimated previously.

BUYING ADVICE

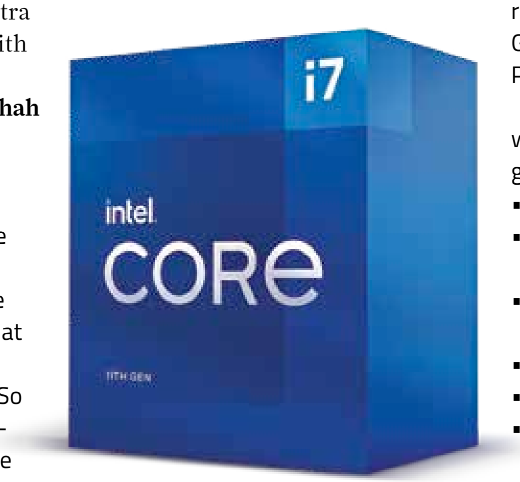
ULTRA HIGH-END GAMING

Q Hi Agent 001,
I am a regular reader of Digit and I see your buying guides and recommendations for PC configurations. I want to buy a PC for data recovery and gaming which should be very fast. All other components are finalised but I am confused about which motherboard to buy. I have selected the following processor Intel Core i9-11900KF. Please suggest a good motherboard for this processor. Money is no bar for me. If possible also do suggest a good ultra high-end system configuration with this processor.

–Tejass.R.Shah

A Hey Tejass,
The choice of motherboard is determined by the use case and the other components that you will be using with your motherboard. Since you've only stated the processor that you want to buy, we have no idea about the rest of the components. So we're going to make a few assumptions along the way. Your first usage scenario is for data recovery. This does not require a high-end configuration. In fact, software such as Recuva don't even bother putting up system requirements aside from the OS on their official web page. Any system that is capable of running a 64-bit Windows OS released in the last 15-20 years is more than capable of running data recovery software. The bottleneck in such systems is the storage media that you are trying to recover data from. If you're recovering data from a hard drive, then you best be using a SATA SSD or better. And if you're recovering data from an SSD then you need a faster SSD, and so on.

On the gaming front, your choice of the processor is very good and it can be paired with either a Z490, Z590 or even a B560 chipset based motherboard. You don't even need a 'Z' chipset if you aren't overclocking or getting SLI. And gamers don't need SLI these days given how very few games are optimised to make proper use of the multi-GPU feature. Also, you have no need for a K-series CPU if you aren't overclocking so you can go for the Intel Core i7-11700 CPU rather than spending more money on the K-variant. It has the same number of cores as the 11900 and the gaming performance is barely apart.



Intel Core i7-11700

As for recommendations, the ASUS TUF GAMING B560M-PLUS Wi-Fi is a pretty great motherboard for the Intel Core i9-11700 as it has a robust VRM and has support for PCIe Gen 4.0 making it ideal for the latest PCIe Gen 4.0 SSDs.

As for a complete configuration, we'd suggest the following for a gaming PC:

- CPU - Intel Core i7-11700
- Motherboard - ASUS TUF GAMING B560M-PLUS Wi-Fi
- RAM - 2x 8GB G.Skill Ripjaws DDR4 3600 MHz
- SSD - WD SN850 1 TB
- CPU Cooler - Noctua NH-U12A
- Graphics Card - NVIDIA GeForce RTX 3080
- Chassis - Lian Li O11D
- HDDs - As required